

Melissa Zamora

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About Me

Senior Software Development professional, 20 years in. Track record of taking ambiguous problems through design, delivery and the unglamorous operational work that follows. I mentor deliberately and write things down. Core stack: TypeScript, Spring Boot, GraphQL.

Professional Experience

Blue Orbit Labs — Principal Backend Developer

August 2019 to March 2026

- » Set the service-level objectives for 6 services and built the dashboards the team still runs on.
- » Partnered with product to scope and deliver 40 major releases, each behind staged rollouts.
- » Mentored 15 junior engineers, ran weekly design reviews, and authored the team's onboarding guide.
- » Refactored the billing module behind a feature flag, eliminating 70% of recurring production incidents.
- » Rewrote the search path in JavaScript, dropping median response from 1200ms to 80ms for 40M monthly users.

Senior Software Engineer

Dell | April 2013 to June 2019

- » Replaced a third-party dependency with an in-house C# module, saving \$15k per year in licence fees.
- » Owned the customer-facing API end to end on C#, from schema design through on-call support.
- » Led the migration of a legacy monolith to TypeScript, taking deployments from fortnightly to 2 per day.
- » Drove the team's adoption of trunk-based development, reducing merge conflicts and lead time by 20%.

Platform Engineer, Airbnb

May 2010 to March 2013

- » Designed and shipped Spring Boot services handling 8k requests per minute, cutting p99 latency from 450ms to 40ms.
- » Cut CI build times by 22% by parallelising the the in-house toolchain pipeline and caching dependency layers.
- » Built a reusable C# component library adopted by 40 product teams, removing months of duplicated work.

Software Engineer, Lumen Works

July 2006 to February 2010

- » Introduced contract testing with pytest, lifting coverage from 8% to 88% and cutting integration bugs.
- » Hardened authentication flows in TypeScript after a security review, closing 40 findings before audit.
- » Standardised the team's tooling with the in-house toolchain, ending long-running environment drift.

Adobe — Mobile Engineer

October 2004 to March 2006

- » Presented the team's work at an internal engineering forum of 40+ colleagues.
- » Reduced technical debt on a legacy component that had blocked 6 previous attempts.
- » Introduced written design docs and an RFC process, cutting rework late in delivery.

Academic Background

Master, Communications

Port Kellymouth Institute of Technology | 2002 to 2004

Thesis: "Framing effects in crisis communication"

Bachelor, Communications

Rodgersville State University | 2001

Key Skills

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Java, SQL, C#

Frameworks: Spring Boot, React, Angular, Scikit-learn

Data: Redis, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Elasticsearch

Testing & Tooling: GraphQL, pytest

Licences & Certifications

HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate — HashiCorp, 2024

Databricks Certified Data Engineer Associate — Databricks, 2026

Languages

English – Bilingual

Mandarin – Fluent

Interests

Travel photography, Jazz guitar, Five-a-side football, Board games